



TIPS & TRICKS



How to create and use the directory

We know that 'mkdir' is used to create a directory and folder, while '&&' is used to combine two commands. We can use the following command to create and use the directory at once:

```
$ mkdir folder && cd $_
```

This will create the directory 'folder' and use it in the terminal, just like the 'cd' command.

—Tushar Kute, tushar@tusharkute.com



A demo of the tee command

The *tee* command reads from standard input and writes to standard output – for one or more files at the same time.

The syntax is:

```
tee [option][file]
```

An example is:

```
history | tee -a history.txt
```

The above command will display the output of the history in both standard output and the file *history.txt*.

—Abhishek Gupta, abhishekgupta.kpg93@gmail.com



Finding out the difference between folders

To find the difference between any two folders, we can use the following command:

```
$diff -qr folder1 folder2
```

The flag 'q' in the above command is used to report only when the files differ, and the flag 'r' recursively reads the sub-directories.

— Gunasekar D, dg.gunasekar@gmail.com



Managing bandwidth on an Ubuntu system

To manage bandwidth on an Ubuntu system, we can use *wondershaper*. This is a traffic-shaping command line tool that can limit the download/upload speed whenever you need to. For example, downloading via Torrent or a download manager in a LAN connection causes a very low speed in another computer.

To use the tool, we need to install it by executing the following command:

```
$sudo apt-get install wondershaper
```

After successful installation, we can execute it, as follows:

```
$wondershaper [network interface] [down speed kbit/s] [up speed kbit/s]
```

Here is an example:

```
wondershaper eth0 1000 500
```

...in which, *eth0* is your network interface name, 1000 is the download speed in kbit/s, and 500 is the upload speed in kbit/s.

To clear the Wondershaper configuration, run the following command:

```
$wondershaper clear eth0
```

You can change the download and upload speeds, according to your needs.

—Prasad Pawan, prasad.pawan@gmail.com

END 

Share Your Open Source Recipes!

The joy of using open source software is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.opensourceforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.